

Introduction to pediatric dentistry



pediatric dentistry

- ▶ The branch of dentistry concerned with the dental care and treatment of children.
- ▶ It has evolved because of the special psychological challenges of children.
- ▶ Many oral conditions of children are not so different from those conditions of adults. But permanent teeth different from primary teeth.

Pediatric dentistry

- ▶ Initial childhood **dental experiences** often set children's lifelong attitudes toward dentistry.
- ▶ It is important that a proper introduction to dentistry be made for children & that close observation and/or therapy be continued from the age of 6–12 months & every 6 months of the life.

Special dental chair







Periodic examination



Pediatric dentistry

► Conditions related to pediatric dentistry:

1. **Caries** in primary teeth(often discolored)
 - Rampant caries
Rapidly progressive caries in many teeth simultaneously.
 - ❖ **Causes:**
 - Prolonged use of bottle at bedtime
 - Diet that composed of sugary foods
 - Salivary deficiency (Xerostomia)



Conditions related to pediatric dentistry:(cont.)

2. Permanent tooth won't come into mouth (**erupt**) or is never formed(**missing**)



Conditions related to pediatric dentistry:(cont.)

3. Primary tooth dark in color after accident.



Change in color



Conditions related to pediatric dentistry:(cont.)

4. Upper & lower teeth do not come together (open bite)



Causes of open bite:

- Thumb & finger sucking
- Pacifier(dummy) sucking
- Mouth breathing



Conditions related to pediatric dentistry:(cont.)

5. Cleft lip & palate



Cleft lip



Conditions related to pediatric dentistry:(cont.)

6. Red puffy gums that bleed easily.



Conditions related to pediatric dentistry:(cont.)

7. Child that is impossible to control during oral therapy or child is physically or mentally handicapped.



Conditions related to pediatric dentistry:(cont.)

8. Discoloration of primary or permanent teeth.



Treatment provided by the pedodontist

- ▶ Many of the conditions in children and the treatment provided are similar for the adults like : restorations (fillings), crowns, periodontal or gum therapyetc

Treatment provided by the pedodontist (cont.)

❖ Some treatment types are specific for children :

1. Pulpotomy (removal of coronal part of the dental pulp)–vital pulp therapy.
2. Stainless steel crowns.
3. Removal of primary teeth.
4. Surgically assisted eruption.
5. Space maintainer

Pulpotomy Procedure



stainless steel crowns



Extraction of primary teeth



Appliance placed to maintain space created by the premature loss of tooth or teeth. (Space maintainers)

